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University, Australia. He went on to be a system engineer at Mercury Software Technologies in Chennai, and continued with the profile at Xchanging, Singapore before his current posting at Alpssoft Technologies. He was kind enough to answer some questions about being a system administrator and how he got where he is.

Balaji Ramarao is our senior consultant for this article. He spent close to 22 years in this field. Educated in Madurai, he's done his graduation with a Post-Graduate Diploma in Systems Development from NIIT. He's also done his training in Madurai, Chennai, Egypt and Bangalore. He has several certifications, including that of an ethical hacker. In the past decade, he was in charge of System Administration & Problem Management at Aditya Birla Minacs Worldwide Limited for over 14 years. He is currently employed as the Senior Manager of IT at Advanced Business & Healthcare Solutions India Pvt Ltd. Even though he started his career as a programmer, his vast experience as a system admin in this field gives us invaluable insight into System Administration.



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A three-step guide to SysAdmin 101

“Yes, I wanted to be a system administrator”, said Ibrahim when asked whether it was always his choice of a vocation. “The steps that I took were along the

course of my life.” He went on to suggest that those who intended to take the same route should cultivate a passion for computers and have an innate desire of keeping a ear to the ground when it comes to learning new things about technology. This is important when it comes to a career in any field. Practice makes perfect. One way to get there is by having a go at learning how to handle and repair your own computer. You will make mistakes, obviously, but it's all part of the learning process. The third step towards becoming a System Administrator is to learn about servers. Subjects such as Windows Active Directory, Mail Servers and FSMO roles are good topics to get a headstart on. A good way to pick up on the basics of System Administration is by doing an MCSA certification, at least.